

Field of Chaos: Just the Rules (2026)

Source of truth: txt/jpc-rpg2.txt. Mechanics only; prose guidance is collected in foc-reference-2026.pdf.

1. Roles, Materials, House Rules, And Disputes

- One Controller directs narration and adjudication. One to ten Players each act through a Character.
- Use at least five six-sided dice, plus paper or another written record for Characters and Controller notes.
- House rules are encouraged, but must be written down and agreed by all participants before play.
- If a rule cannot be found in about two minutes, resolve the dispute with a die roll.
- For two positions, assign odd and even. For three, assign 1/4, 2/5, and 3/6. Larger disputes must first consolidate into two or three positions.

2. Statistics And Character Generation

Statistic	Abbrev.	Rules use
Regular Intelligence	RE	Academic knowledge and the broadest formal skill base.
Irregular Intelligence	IR	Improvised, informal, or cross-field understanding.
Appearance	AP	Presentation, status fit, disguise, and blending into an environment.
Physical Health	PH	Health, strenuous activity, movement, and physical skills.
Mental Health	ME	Mental state, fatigue, self-control, and operational skills.

Character Generation

- Roll three d6 and record all three values.
- Choose any two rolls and also record their opposite faces: 7 minus the original value.
- You now have five values: x, y, z, 7-x, and 7-y.
- Add +2 to one chosen value and +1 to each other value.
- Assign the five final values to RE, IR, AP, PH, and ME.
- Each statistic ranges from 0 to 10. The initial total cannot exceed 30; detailed play may raise the combined maximum to 40.

3. Skills

- A Player is allowed one skill per statistic point in the corresponding area.
- Prerequisite skills count against this allowance.
- Skills are learned through their prerequisite paths; the Controller may add further skills through agreed house rules.

Area	Available skills and paths
RE	Anti-Viral Software <- Computer Programming; Artificial Intelligence <- Computer Programming; Biology, Basic; Botany <- Basic Biology + Horticulture; Cartography <- Basic Geography + Visual Art; Chemistry, Basic; Chemistry, Advanced <- Basic Chemistry; Chemistry, Pharmaceutical <- Advanced Chemistry + Basic Biology; Computer Operation; Computer Programming <- Computer Operation; Computer Repair; Cryptography <- Advanced Mathematics; Copyediting <- Primary Written Language; Drive Tracked Vehicle <- Drive Car; Electronics, Basic; Electronics Repair/Operation <- Basic Electronics; First Aid; Geography, Basic; Gun-Smithing, Basic <- Advanced Firearm Use; History, Basic; Horticulture; Language Written, Primary <- Primary Spoken Language; Mathematics, Basic/Advanced; Mechanic, Auto Advanced <- Basic Auto Mechanic; Musical Performance; Paramedic <- First Aid; Psychology, Basic; Zoology <- Basic Biology.
IR	Computer Virus Creation <- Computer Programming; Explosive Engineering <- Basic Chemistry; Forgery <- Visual Art; Lock-picking; Hacking <- Computer Operation; Hunting; Manufacture Clandestine Weapon <- Carpentry; Track <- Disguise; Improvised Weapon Use, Basic; Clandestine Weapon Use, Basic; Wilderness Survival, Advanced <- Basic Wilderness Survival.
AP	Disguise; Evade; Etiquette <- Basic Manners; Orate <- Primary Spoken Language; Scouting <- Basic Geography + Advanced Wilderness Survival.
PH	Canoeing; Carpentry; Close Combat; Cycling; Marching; Running; Sailboating; Swimming; Firearm Use, Basic (all firearms); Wilderness Survival, Basic; Firearm Use, Shotgun <- Basic Firearm Use.
ME	Drive Car; Drive Motorcycle; Firearm Use, Advanced <- Basic Firearm Use (specific to Rifle or SubMG); Firearm Use, Sniper <- Advanced Firearm Use (Rifle); Interrogation <- Basic Psychology; Impersonate <- Disguise; Language Spoken, Primary/Secondary; Manners, Basic; Pilot Plane <- Drive Car; Visual Art.

4. Ranged Weapons

Weapon	Close	Standard	Long
Sniper Rifle	288 yards	432 yards	576 yards
Rifle	216 yards	324 yards	432 yards
SubMG	96 yards	192 yards	-

Range	Dice	Required	Skill notes
Close	1d6 / +1* / +2**	4-6	* Basic Firearm Use; Advanced for sniper.
Standard	2d6 / +1* / +2**	8-12	** Advanced for that weapon; Sniper skill for sniper.
Long	3d6 / +1* / +2**	14-18	SubMG has no long-range band.

Modifiers

Condition	Modifier
Some Cover	-1 die
Target moving Fast	-1 die
Target has Evade	-1 die

Shots And Movement

Weapon	Shots per turn	Movement	Special
Sniper Rifle	1	Cannot move and fire	-
Rifle	1; 2 with weapon-specific Advanced skill	Slow; Standard with Advanced	-
SubMG	4	Fast	Jams on any 1 in the used roll

- A standard clip contains 10 rounds. Changing a clip or clearing a jam takes one turn.

Movement

Pace	Distance	Skill effect
Slow	2 yards/second	+1 with Evade
Standard	4 yards/second	+2 with Marching
Fast	7 yards/second	+3 with Running

5. Bullet Hits, Wounds, And Melee

2d6 result	Location	Probability
4	Left Arm	3/36
6	Left Leg	5/36
8	Right Leg	5/36
10	Right Arm	3/36
12	Head	1/36
Any other result	Body	19/36

Location	Wounds
Head	1W
Body	4W
Left Arm	1W
Right Arm	1W
Left Leg	2W
Right Leg	2W
Total	11W

- One leg at 0W halves movement; both legs at 0W prevent movement.
- One arm at 0W prevents firearm use. Head or Body at 0W causes unconsciousness.
- Below 6 total wounds, roll 2d6 each turn; above PH causes unconsciousness.
- At no wounds remaining, the Character is dead.
- A single Body wound can wind a Character: roll 2d6; above PH means no action for roll minus PH turns.

Melee check	Requirement	Dice
Blow	2-6	1d6 / +1* / +2**
Weapon	3-6	1d6 / +1* / +2**

- * Close Combat for a blow or weapon, or Clandestine/Improvised Weapon Use where applicable. ** Close Combat plus the applicable Clandestine/Improvised Weapon skill for a weapon.

6. Healing And Initiative

- No medical skill: roll 1d6 each turn; on 6 recover one wound. Equipment changes the threshold to 5-6.
- First Aid: roll 2d6 and retain the highest. Paramedic: roll 3d6 and retain the highest.
- Pharmaceutical Chemistry: roll 4d6 and retain the top two, allowing up to two wounds recovered at the normal threshold.
- At the start of battle, Players have initiative. Order among Players is 2d6 + Mental Health.

7. Foes

Foe	Rules
Animal	Head shot releases Psychosis Gas; an animal head shot succeeds only on 5-6 on d6. Gas attack doubles required rolls and halves movement. Cloud radius is 3d6 + 12 yards; it shrinks 6 yards per turn and drifts 6 yards in a d6 direction. Animal receives +1 die on attacks.
Hunter	+1 movement.
Soldiers	Each shot wound has an armor save on 5-6 on d6, including head shots.

8. Shotgun

- The cone is 45 yards long and 9 yards wide at its end.

Occupied band	Area	Damage
Near	First 10 yards; 2 yards wide	2d6 wounds
Middle, only if Near empty	First 20 yards; 4 yards wide	d6 wounds
Far, only if nearer bands empty	First 30 yards; 6 yards wide	d3 wounds (d6/2, round up)

9. Grenade

- Maximum throw is 50 yards. Throwing a grenade halves movement or other abilities; a stationary Character may throw two grenades.

Distance from grenade	Damage
Within 3 yards	d6 wounds
Within 6 yards	d3 wounds (d6/2, round up)
Within 9 yards	d2 wounds (d6/3, round down)

- A grenade inside a building with at least two walls doubles its effective radius.
- Roll 2d6 for reliability on every throw. On 4 or less, the grenade is a dud.
- Grenade debris creates Some Cover for shots through the blast area.